

User Guide

Posters and text cards — prehistoric animals

What is included

This set contains the following parts:

- 10 A3 posters showing prehistoric animals in size relation to a child
- Text cards in three variants: name only, name and type, name and facts
- This user guide

How to prepare the material

1. Print the A3 posters on A3 paper for full effect. Posters can also be printed in smaller format if desired.
2. Cut the text cards along the dashed line.
3. Laminate both posters and cards for lasting use.
4. Cut out small labels with each animal's name and stick them on the back of each poster. This makes the posters self-correcting.

How the child uses the material

The material can be used in several ways, depending on the child's age and experience:

Stage 1 — The youngest (3–5 years)

- The child explores the posters and gets to know the animals.
- The adult can name the animals while the child observes.
- The child matches name-only text cards to the correct poster.
- Self-check: the child turns the poster over to see if the name is correct.

Stage 2 — Middle stage (5–7 years)

- The child uses name-and-type cards to sort the animals.
- Questions for conversation: Which animals are plant-eaters? Which are predators?

- The child can categorise animals by habitat (land, sea, air).

Stage 3 — The oldest (7–9 years)

- The child uses fact cards to learn more about each animal.
- The material connects to the Timeline of Life — when in time did the animals live?
- The child can create their own stories or drawings.

Self-correcting material

In line with the Montessori tradition, the material is self-correcting. When the child sticks the name on the back of each poster, they can check their own answer by turning the poster over. This gives the child the freedom to work independently and learn from their own mistakes — without the adult needing to intervene.

Tips from the guide

- Present the material calmly and beautifully.
- Let the child observe for a long time before you speak together.
- Use open questions that awaken wonder.
- Compare the size between the child on the poster and the animal.
- The material can be used alone, in pairs, or in small groups.

Enjoy the work! 🌍